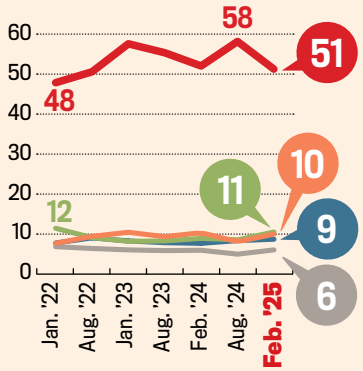
Q. What's your assessment of Budget 2025?

It will accelerate growth and generate employment	28
It will help farmers	13
It will boost manufacturing	6
It was meant to please the middle class	14
It will do all of the above	6
It will do none of the above	23

Rest others; DK/ CS

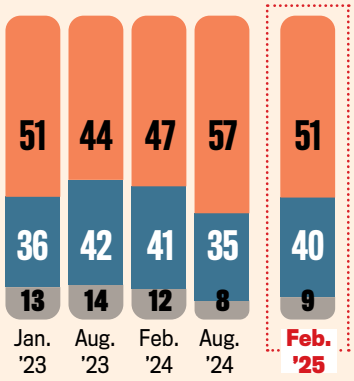
Some see growth potential in the budget, but many doubt its overall impact on the economy

Q. Who do you think has benefited the most from the NDA government's economic policies?



Rest others; DK/CS

Q. Who, in your opinion, has better managed the overall Indian economy?

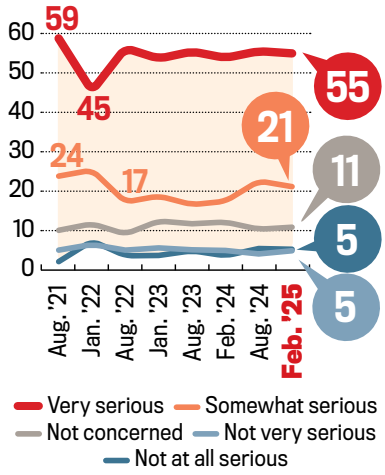


Modi remains the preferred economic manager, but Manmohan's approval has risen

TAX CUTS NOT ENOUGH

It is evident that income tax sops alone are not going to make much of a difference to the middle class's lot, which numbers 570 million, as per estimates of Delhi-based think tank People Research on India's Consumer Economy (PRICE). PRICE categorises the middle class as households with an annual income between Rs 5 lakh and Rs 30 lakh at FY21 prices, or between Rs 6 lakh and Rs 36 lakh at current prices. Although the RBI managed to rein in retail inflation to 5.2 per cent in December 2024 through a tight monetary policy, food inflation remained high at 8.4 per cent. High fuel prices are another factor that pinches the average Indian's budget. It is no surprise, therefore, that while 43.6 per cent of the respondents say the hike in the income tax exemption would boost their savings and spending, another 34.6 per cent believe it would not.

Q. How do you view the unemployment situation in the country?



A majority view unemployment as serious, with concerns remaining high from last time

All figures in % and rounded off

A significant 68 per cent of the respondents appreciate the budget, particularly its emphasis on growth, job creation, the middle class and the farm sector. In contrast, nearly a quarter of those surveyed are sceptical about the budget's impact on India's economic development.

BOOST FOR BIG BUSINESS

The perception that the government's economic policies mostly benefit big business has remained steady across several MOTN surveys. Over half of the respondents have felt this way since the MOTN of August 2022. In the latest survey, the figure is 51.2 per cent, though this is lower than the 58.3 per cent recorded in the previous survey. Offering some relief to the Centre is the perception that small businesses and farmers are also gaining, with their share rising to 10 per cent and 10.6 per cent, respectively, compared to 8 per